How-To Library

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Importing Metadata from Relational Sources in Test Data Management

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Abstract

You can create a relational database connection and import metadata from the connection in Test Data Management (TDM). Use the imported metadata to perform TDM operations. This article describes how to create a relational database connection, create a project, and import metadata directly from the database connection.

Supported Versions

- Test Data Management 9.5.1 to 9.6.0
- Test Data Management 9.6.1
- Test Data Management 9.6.1 HotFix 1
- Test Data Management 9.7.0
- Test Data Management 9.7.1
- Test Data Management 9.7.1 HotFix 1
- Test Data Management 10.1.0
- Test Data Management 10.2.0

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Overview

Create a relational database connection in Test Data Manager and use the connection as a source or target connection when you perform TDM operations. Create a project and import metadata from the database connection to perform data discovery, subset, masking, and generation operations.

When you create a connection in Test Data Manager, TDM stores the connection information in the Model repository.

A project is the top-level container that you use to organize the components for data discovery, masking, subset, and generation operations. Create a project in Test Data Manager and import metadata into the TDM repository. If the source contains many tables, you can increase the performance if you import the metadata directly from the source instead of from PowerCenter.

You can select the following relational database connection types directly: Oracle, Microsoft SQL Server, Sybase, and DB2 for Linux, Unix, and Windows

Scenario

You work for a software testing department in an organization. You need test data to test a new banking application. To perform TDM operations and create test data, you need metadata. In Test Data Manager, create a relational database connection. Create a project and import metadata directly from the relational database connection. Use the imported metadata to perform data subset, data masking, data discovery, and data generation operations to create the test data.

Step 1. Create a Relational Database Connection

You can create a relational database connection in Test Data Manager. Use the connection as a source, a target, and to import metadata into a project.

1. In the **Administrator | Connections** view, select **New Connection** from the **Actions** menu.

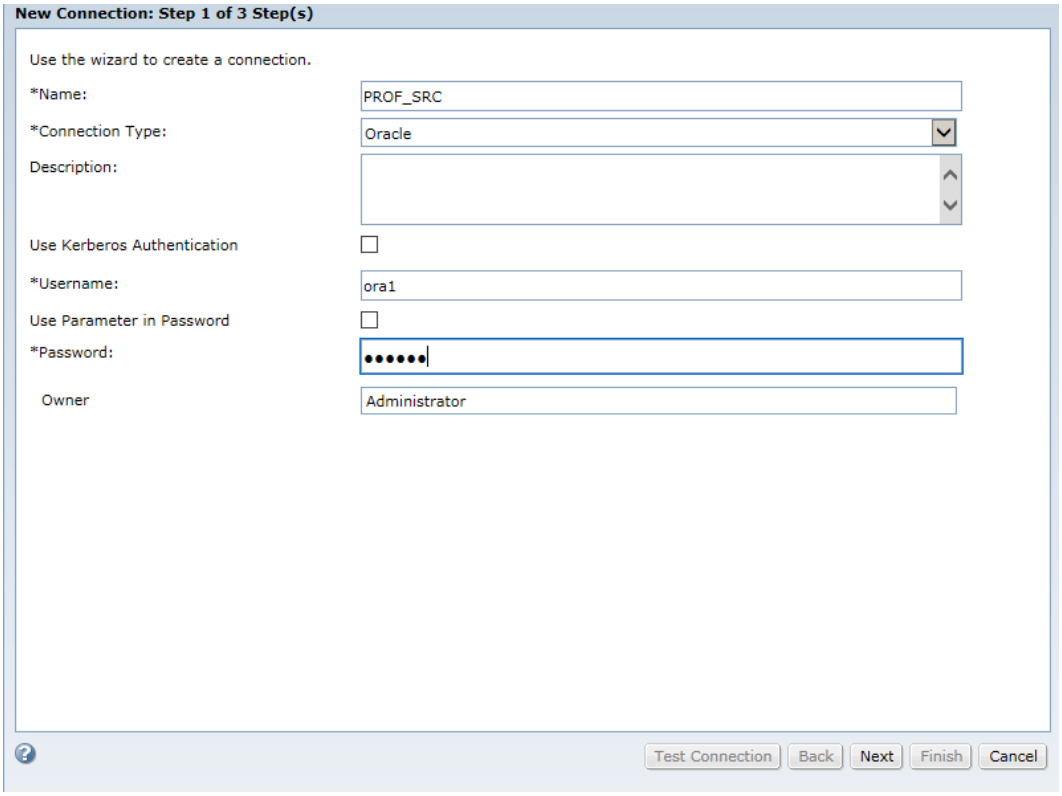
   A tab opens to display the connection properties.

2. Select the connection type. You can select the following connection types: Oracle, Microsoft SQL Server, Sybase, and DB2 for Linux, Unix, and Windows

3. Define the connection name, description, and user information.

   The connection name must begin with an alphabetic character. If you enter a connection name that begins with a numeric character, a workflow that includes the connection might fail.

   The following image shows the Oracle database connection properties that you can configure:

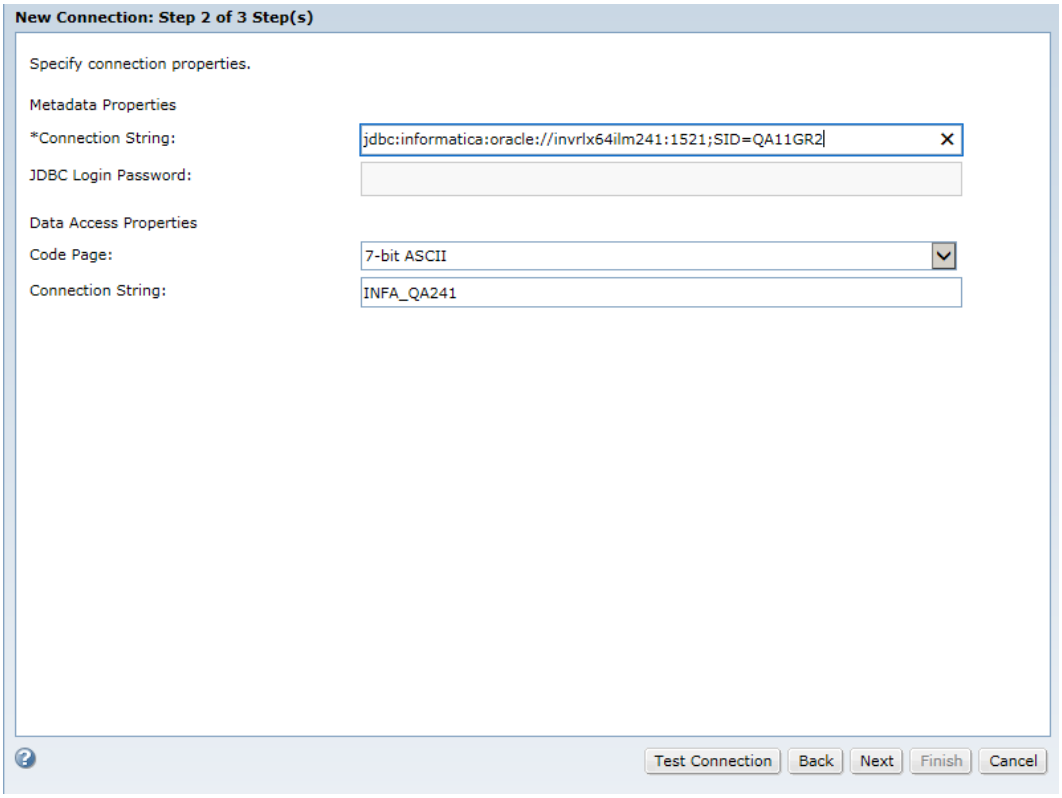


4. Click **Next**.

   Based on the connection type that you select, the connection properties appear.

5. Enter the connection properties such as connection string, code page, and JDBC connection string.

The following image shows the connection properties that you can configure for a relational database connection:



6. Click **Next**.
7. Enter the PowerCenter properties.
8. To test the connection, click **Test Connection**.
9. To save the connection, click **Finish**.

   The connection is visible in the **Administrator** | **Connections** view.

Step 2. Create a Project and Import Metadata

Create a project to store the TDM components. Import metadata from a relational database connection, and use the metadata to perform TDM operations.

1. In Test Data Manager, click **Projects** to access the projects.

   A list of projects appears.
2. Click **Actions** > **New**.
3. In the **Create Project** dialog box, enter a project name and the project properties. The following fields are automatically populated:

   PowerCenter Repository

   The name of the PowerCenter repository to store the repository folder.

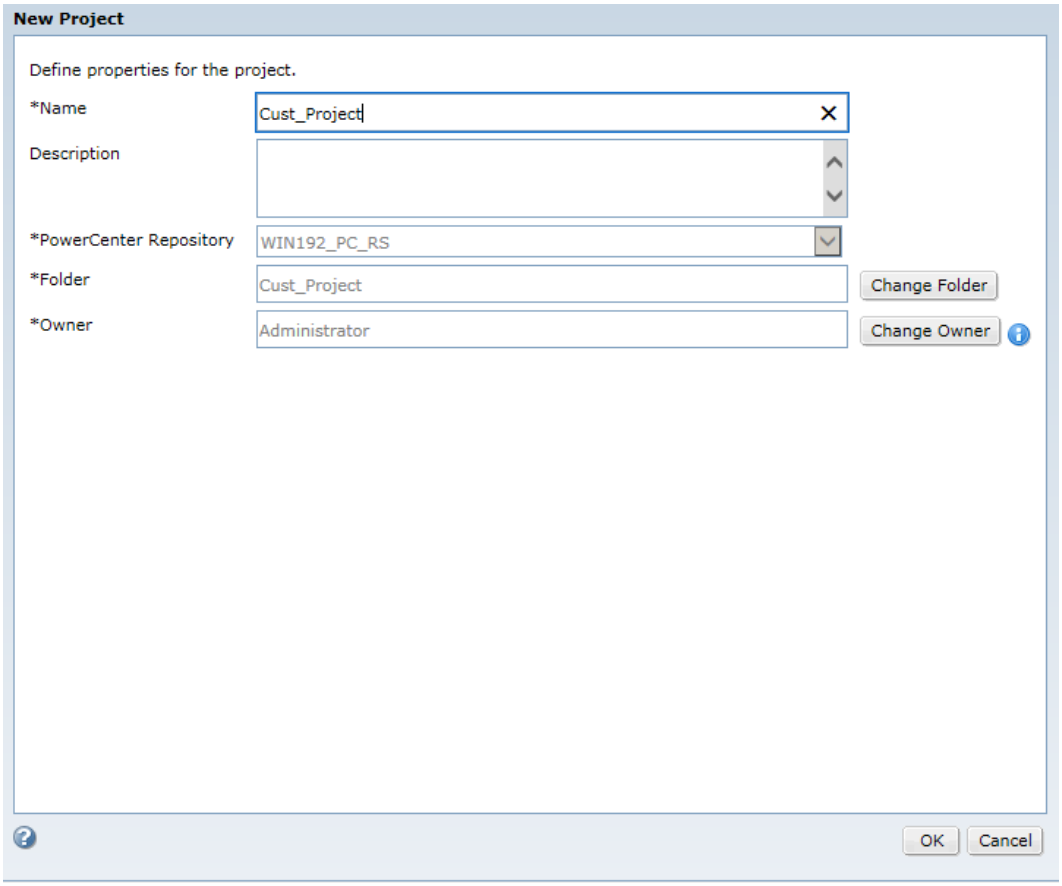
Folder

The name of the project folder in the repository. The default is the project name. You can choose another folder in the repository.

Owner

The name of the user that owns the project. The project owner has all permissions on the project. The default is the name of the user that created the project. You can select another user as the project owner.

The following image shows the project properties that you can configure:



4. Click **OK**.

   The properties of the project appear in Test Data Manager.

5. Click **Actions** > **Import Metadata**.

   The **Import Metadata** window appears.

6. To import metadata from a database connection, select **Datasource Connection**. Select the relational database connection that you created.

7. Skip the review of metadata changes before you import.

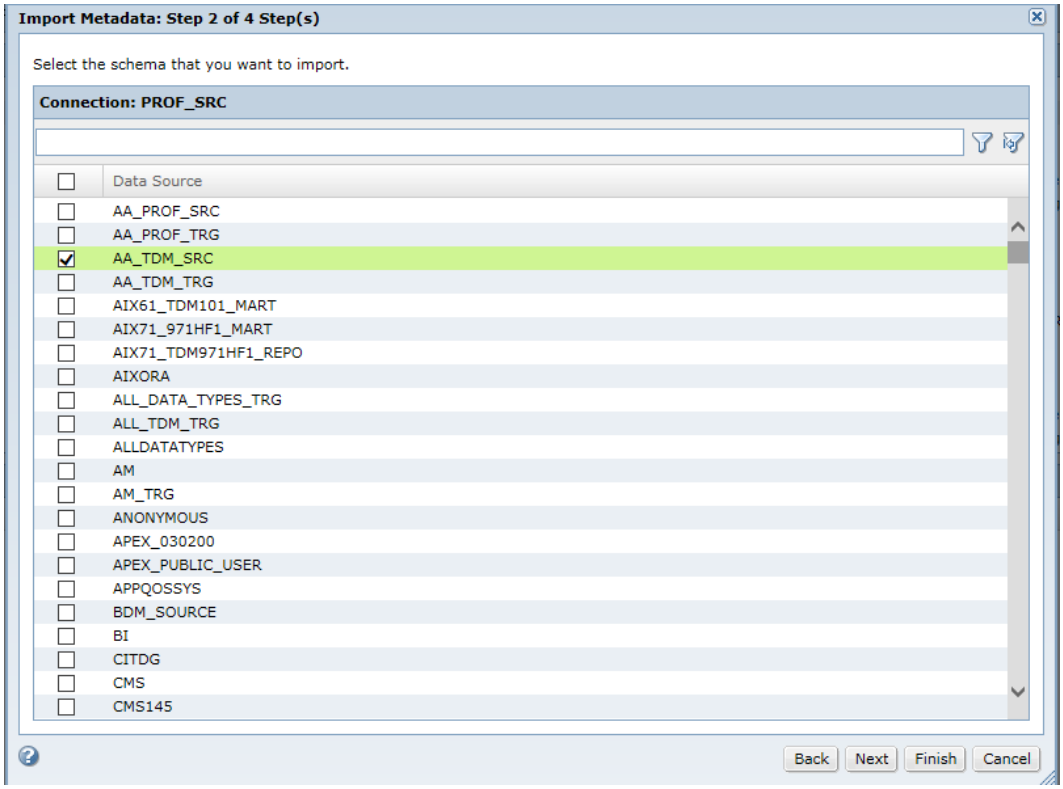
8. If you select an Oracle database connection, you can choose to ignore the tables that do not contain any data.

   Test Data Manager excludes all the empty tables in the Oracle database and lists the tables that contain data.

9. Click **Next**.

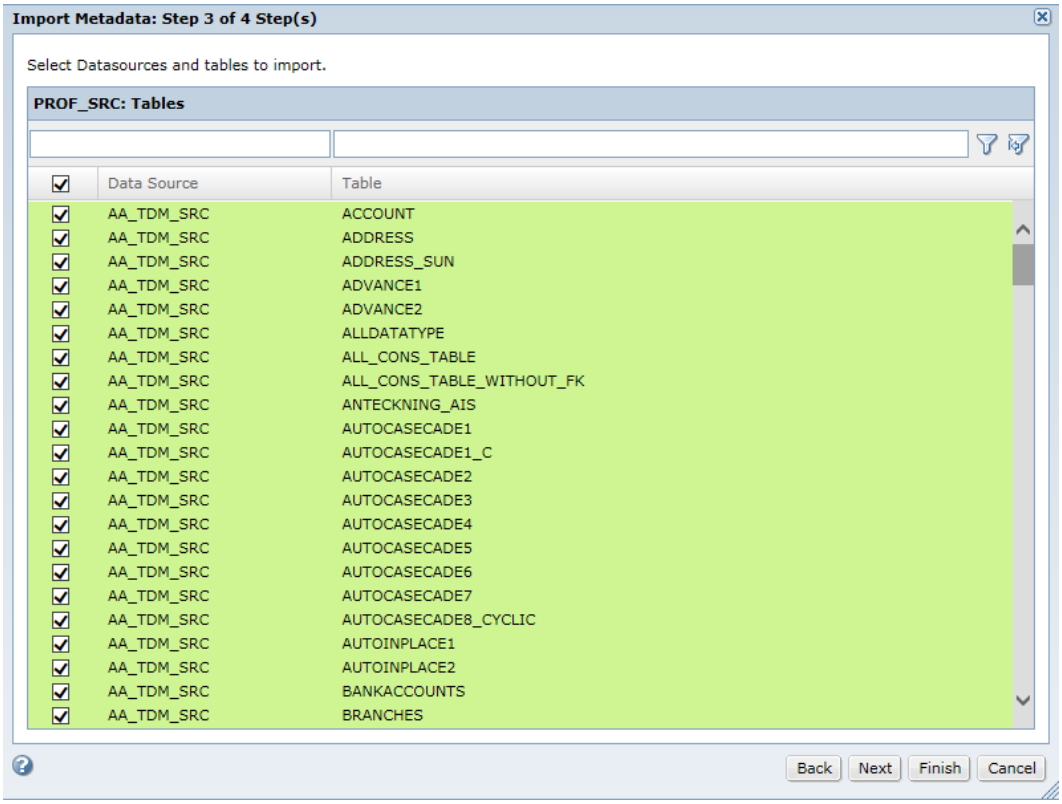
10. Select the schema that you want to import. You can filter schemas by schema name.

    The following image shows the schema that you want to import from the database:



11. Click **Next**.
12. Select the tables that you want to import. You can filter the tables by data source or table name.

The following image shows the tables that the schema contains:



13. Click **Next**.
14. To import the data source immediately, click **Import Now**.
15. Click **Finish**.

    The **Import Progress** dialog box appears with the import progress bar.
16. View the progress of the import job in the **Monitor** view.

    TDM imports the metadata successfully. After the job finishes, access the imported metadata from the **Project** > **Discover** > **Tables** page.

Author

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